



# The Weekly AI Check-In

*Build the habit. Ten minutes a week.*

*Made for the Ones Who Move Different.*

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— EJOSHI —

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## SECTION 01

# WHY A WEEKLY HABIT CHANGES EVERYTHING

AI skills don't come from reading about AI. They come from trying things, noticing what works, and adjusting.

Ten minutes a week — the same ten minutes, on the same day, with the same simple template — is the habit loop that turns occasional AI users into people who actually think with the tool.

This kit is the calmest version of that loop. A simple template you fill in. The question behind each part. Worked examples from a fictional learner so you can see what a real check-in looks like. A gentler first-week version so the habit actually starts. A monthly compounding review for after the weekly habit takes root. And a skill snapshot — the six stages of AI fluency, so you can see growth without grades.

Total reading time: about ten minutes. Total practice time per week: ten minutes. The habit is supposed to be small. That's what makes it work.

## Who this is for

- Self-directed learners who want to get good at AI without taking a course.
- Anyone who's read three guides and not retained any of them.
- People who already use AI casually and want to use it on purpose.
- Anyone who likes habits more than they like content.

## What this kit is not

It's not a productivity hack. It's not a journal prompt. It's not a "track your AI usage" tool in the surveillance sense. It's a five-to-ten minute weekly habit that helps you notice what you're actually learning — which most people never do, with anything, ever. The habit happens to be about AI. The habit itself is older than AI by a long way.

**The Ejoshi promise.** Always honest. Built for everyone, not just the people who already know. Free to access. No paywall. No gatekeeping. The future shouldn't be locked behind a paywall.

## SECTION 02

## THE 10-MINUTE CHECK-IN TEMPLATE

Five parts. Ten minutes total. Same day each week.

## Part 1 — What I tried this week

Up to three things you used AI for this week. The tool, the task, one sentence each. That's it.

The question behind the question: *what is my AI life actually shaped like, when I'm not thinking about it?*  
Most people's AI use looks different than they think. The list reveals the truth.

## Part 2 — Honest assessment

For each thing you tried, four quick checks:

- Did it save time? (yes / no / unclear)
- Was the output useful without heavy editing? (yes / no / partial)
- Did it help you understand something better? (yes / no / N/A)
- Would you use this approach again? (yes / no / maybe with changes)

The question behind the question: *where is my judgment growing?* The answers aren't grades. They're calibration data — for you, about how well you're picking which tasks to give to AI.

## Part 3 — What I noticed

Three open prompts:

- One thing AI did surprisingly well this week.
- One thing AI got wrong or that surprised you.
- One moment you chose not to trust the AI's answer.

The question behind the question: *what is my pattern recognition telling me?* These are the moments you remember a month later. Writing them down is what turns experience into skill.

## Part 4 — Next week's experiment

Pick ONE new thing to try with AI next week. Fill in: "*I will try using AI to \_\_\_\_\_. I'll know it worked if \_\_\_\_\_. I'll do it on [day], at [time].*"

The question behind the question: *am I still curious?* The week you skip this prompt is the week the habit goes stale. The week you pick something specific is the week the habit grows.

## Part 5 — Skill snapshot

A single sentence: *"This week, I got better at \_\_\_\_."*

If you can't finish that sentence, that's information too. Some weeks, the answer is "nothing — and that's okay." Other weeks it's "noticing when AI was confidently wrong." The variety is the point.

**The whole loop.** Tried → assessed → noticed → planned → snapshot. Ten minutes.  
Same day. Same template. Save them — you'll want to look back.

## SECTION 03

# A WORKED EXAMPLE

What a real check-in might look like. Fictional learner. Real shape.

## Part 1 — What I tried

- ChatGPT — Asked it to rewrite my cover letter in three voices.
- Claude — Asked it to summarize a long article I didn't have time to read.
- Gemini — Used it to settle an argument with my partner about a recipe.

## Part 2 — Honest assessment

- Cover letter: time saved YES; useful without editing PARTIAL (kept the structure, rewrote about half); learned NO; do again YES.
- Summary: time saved YES; useful without editing YES; learned PARTIAL (still don't fully trust the summary); do again YES with verification.
- Recipe argument: time saved NEUTRAL; useful YES; learned YES (the AI's reasoning surprised both of us); do again YES.

## Part 3 — What I noticed

- AI did surprisingly well: capturing the tone I wanted in the cover letter when I gave it three voice references.
- AI got wrong: a date in the article summary. Sounded confident. Was off by two years.
- Chose not to trust: the AI's claim that the recipe needed an ingredient neither my partner nor I had ever heard of. We Googled. The AI was just wrong.

## Part 4 — Next week's experiment

*"I will try using AI to plan my Monday morning. I'll know it worked if I have a clearer list by 9am than I usually do. I'll do it Sunday night, at 9pm."*

## Part 5 — Skill snapshot

*"This week, I got better at catching AI being wrong about specific dates and facts I could check."*

**What this shows.** The check-in isn't a journal. It's calibration. Five minutes of writing reveals what kind of AI user you actually are this week — and what to adjust next week.



## SECTION 04

# YOUR FIRST CHECK-IN — A GENTLER VERSION

Week one is hard. The full template feels like homework. Try this instead.

## The 5-minute Week 1 version

Two questions. That's it.

1. What did I use AI for at all this week? (Even one thing counts.) 2. What's one thing I want to try with AI next week?

That's the entire first check-in. Five minutes. Two questions. No assessment, no notice section, no snapshot. The point of Week 1 is not depth. It's making sure you actually do Week 2.

## Why the gentler start matters

The full template will feel obvious by Week 3. By Week 5 you'll add to it. By Week 10 you'll have customized it to your own pattern. None of that happens if Week 1 was too hard and you skipped Week 2.

## The habit-loop science (briefly)

Habits stick when the cue is consistent, the action is small, and the reward is visible. The check-in nails all three: cue (same day, same time), small action (five to ten minutes, no thinking required), visible reward (the entry itself — written proof that you noticed something this week). Most "track your progress" habits fail because the entry feels like homework. This one is short enough that it doesn't.

## When to graduate to the full template

When the two-question version feels too small. Usually around Week 3 or 4. Don't force it. The habit is the win; the depth is the consequence.

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## SECTION 05

# THE MONTHLY COMPOUNDING REVIEW

Once a month — usually the first weekend — open up the last four check-ins together.

## The four questions for the monthly review

1. *What's a pattern I see across the month that I didn't see in any single week?* 2. *What kept showing up on my "AI got wrong" list?* 3. *Which of my "next week experiments" actually happened? Which got skipped?* 4. *Am I getting better at the same things, or am I broadening?*

The monthly review is where the compound shows up. A single check-in reveals one week's truth. Four together reveal the shape of your AI practice — and where it's drifting.

## What to do with what you notice

Adjust ONE thing for the next month. Not three. Not five. One. The constraint matters. Most people who track habits change too many things at once and lose the signal in the noise.

A few common adjustments people make:

- *"I keep forgetting to verify. Next month, I'll add a verification line to my check-in."*
- *"I'm only using AI for writing. Next month, I'll try one decision-making prompt per week."*
- *"My 'next week experiments' keep being too ambitious. Next month, I'll write smaller ones."*
- *"I keep using the same prompt over and over. Next month, I'll try one new prompt pattern per week."*
- *"I'm reaching for AI on tasks where I should be doing the thinking myself. Next month, I'll add a 'should I do this myself?' check before I open the AI tool."*

**The compound.** Twelve monthly reviews in a year. Each one adjusts one thing. You finish the year with twelve calibrations to your AI practice — most people finish the year with zero.



## SECTION 06

# THE SKILL SNAPSHOT — SIX STAGES OF AI FLUENCY

A rough map of where AI users end up over time. No grades, no ages, no targets. Just a map. Look at it once a quarter. Notice where you are.

## Stage 1 — Curious

You've heard about AI. You've maybe tried a chatbot once or twice. You don't quite know what it's for in your life.

## Stage 2 — Trying

You're experimenting. Sometimes the answer is great; sometimes it's weird; you can't quite predict which. You're learning the tool by using it.

## Stage 3 — Noticing

You're starting to see patterns. You know what kinds of questions AI handles well and which ones it doesn't. You catch it being wrong sometimes.

## Stage 4 — Adjusting

You're tuning your prompts on purpose. You add context, set roles, name constraints. The AI's answers are usefully different than they were three months ago.

## Stage 5 — Choosing

You decide what to use AI for and what to do yourself. You know what AI can't replace in your work — and you protect those parts.

## Stage 6 — Composing

You combine AI with other tools, other workflows, other people. AI is one of many instruments in your toolkit. You use the right one for each job. AI isn't special anymore — it's just one of the tools that lives on the desk.

## What's NOT on this map

There's no Stage 7. Past Composing, the skill isn't really about AI anymore — it's about being a clear thinker with good tools. The point of the check-in isn't to reach a final stage. It's to keep moving, slowly, in the direction of choosing better, thinking clearer, and putting AI down when AI is the wrong tool.

**The honest catch.** Most people stall between Stage 3 and Stage 4. The check-in habit is what gets you across. Noticing what works and adjusting weekly is the work that moves people from "AI user" to "AI-fluent."

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## SECTION 07

# WHAT GROWTH ACTUALLY LOOKS LIKE

Three signs you've moved a stage forward.

## Sign 1 — Your prompts got shorter

Counterintuitive, but real. Stage 3 users write long, careful prompts. Stage 5 users write short, sharp ones. They've learned what to leave out, not just what to put in. Shorter prompts that get great answers are a sign you're calibrating well.

## Sign 2 — You stopped showing off

Stage 2 users tell other people about AI a lot. They share the cool thing it just did, the funny mistake it made, the impressive output they got. Stage 5 users mostly stop talking about AI. They just use it. The talking falls away because the novelty did. That silence is a kind of fluency.

## Sign 3 — You know when to put it down

The clearest sign. You've started catching yourself reaching for AI on tasks where it would actually slow you down or shortcut something that matters. The thirty-second decision — *"is this an AI task or a me task?"* — became automatic.

## Sign 4 — You can teach someone else

A bonus sign. The clearest test of fluency in anything is whether you can teach it. If a friend asked you how to use AI well, and your answer is concrete — specific habits, specific prompts, specific cautions — you're past the noticing stage. You've built something teachable. The check-ins were the work that built it.

## Sign 5 — Your AI use looks boring from the outside

The deepest sign. People at Stage 5 and 6 don't have spectacular AI stories. They have small, daily moments where AI saved them a few minutes, or surfaced one thing they'd missed, or drafted something they then edited. The work looks routine. That's the point — the spectacle has been replaced by usefulness.

**The pattern.** Skill isn't about doing more with AI. It's about choosing better what to do with AI. The check-in is the practice that builds the choosing.

## SECTION 08

# A LAST NOTE

Habits build people, slowly, over months you barely notice. AI fluency is the byproduct here, not the goal — the goal is becoming the kind of person who notices things on purpose. Most of the AI advice circulating online is content; this is a habit. The difference matters.

If you do this check-in once and never again, you'll have gained almost nothing. If you do it weekly for three months, you'll be a meaningfully different AI user. If you do it for a year, you'll have something none of the AI courses can teach you: a personal, calibrated, hard-earned read on what AI does for YOU specifically.

The check-in is small enough to do. Small enough that you actually will. That's the whole design.

## A note on missed weeks

You will miss some. Vacation. Sickness. A week that just got away from you. That's fine. The habit isn't perfect attendance. The habit is coming back after the missed week, without making a big deal of it.

The people who keep this practice for a year aren't the ones who never miss. They're the ones who don't quit after missing. Two weeks off, then back to it. That's how habits actually survive — not perfection, just persistence after a stumble or two.

Start with Week 1's two-question version. Save the check-ins. Come back next week, and the week after, and the week after that.

— Ejoshi ejoshi.ai